

D266

World History: Diverse Cultures and Global Connections

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

Historians studying the outbreak of World War I note that the heir to the Austro-Hungarian throne was shot in Sarajevo in June 1914, on a Sunday morning after his driver took a wrong turn. For decades before that, Europe's great powers had built rival alliance systems and raced to expand their armies. Which factor is best described as a root cause of the war rather than its trigger?

- A. The rival alliance systems and arms buildup that could turn a local crisis into a continent-wide war.
- B. The shooting alone, because without it no war could ever have happened.
- C. The driver's wrong turn that put the car in the gunman's path.
- D. The shooting in Sarajevo in June 1914.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which of the following was a trigger (immediate cause) of the French Revolution rather than a root cause?

- A. Enlightenment ideas about popular sovereignty and natural rights.
- B. Decades of tax burdens falling mainly on the Third Estate while nobles and clergy were largely exempt.
- C. The king's calling of the Estates-General in 1789 to deal with a debt crisis.
- D. The general rise of European population in the 1700s.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A student writing her paper in the university library's rare-books room notes that the Western Roman Empire fell in 476 CE, a few generations after Christianity became its official religion. She concludes that Christianity caused the fall. Which is the best evaluation of her reasoning?

- A. Religion never influences political events, so her claim must be false.
- B. Timing alone does not prove cause; historians weigh several factors such as money troubles, military pressure on the borders, and political instability.
- C. Her claim is stronger because it is based on rare primary documents in a special collection.
- D. Her conclusion is sound because one event came shortly before the other.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

In the 1500s, a state ruled from a single capital over Turks, Arabs, Greeks, Armenians, and Slavs, and it let religious communities run many of their own affairs. It fielded a famous infantry corps and controlled major trade routes. How is this state best classified?

- A. A trading league, because it controlled major trade routes.
- B. An empire.
- C. A city-state.
- D. A nation-state.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which feature most clearly distinguishes a nation-state from an empire?

- A. It rules many distinct peoples from one dominant center.
- B. It has a large standing army.
- C. Its borders are meant to match a people who share a national identity, and its authority rests on that nation.
- D. It always has a king or queen as head of state.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

Between about the 100s and 700s CE, merchants on the overland Silk Road carried silk, horses, and ideas between India, Central Asia, and China. Buddhist monks in China translated texts using existing Daoist terms, and Chinese Buddhism later blended with local ancestor-honoring practices. Caravans could take months to cross the Taklamakan Desert. Which process does this best illustrate?

- A. Cultural isolation, since China kept outside ideas from changing its beliefs.
- B. Environmental limits on trade, since desert crossings took months.
- C. Forced conversion following military conquest.
- D. Cultural diffusion with syncretism, as a religion spread along trade routes and blended with local traditions.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

The plague of the 1340s moved from Central Asia to the Black Sea and then by ship to Mediterranean ports within a few years. Chroniclers in Italian cities described church bells ringing for funerals day and night. Which factor best explains how quickly the disease crossed such distances?

- A. Busy, connected trade routes across Eurasia moved people, goods, and infected rodents and fleas quickly.
- B. The disease began in Italy and moved east along trade routes.
- C. Only poor hygiene in European towns explains the spread.
- D. Ships returning from the Americas brought it to Europe.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

In the century after Spanish expeditions reached central Mexico in the early 1500s, the Indigenous population fell by as much as 90 percent. The Spanish brought horses and steel weapons and formed alliances with rival Indigenous groups. What was the leading cause of the population collapse?

- A. Old World diseases such as smallpox, to which Indigenous peoples had no prior exposure.
- B. Famine after potatoes and maize arrived from Europe.
- C. Battle deaths caused by steel weapons and horses.
- D. Diseases carried from the Americas that weakened the Spanish.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which item moved from the Americas to Afro-Eurasia in the Columbian Exchange and later helped feed population growth there?

- A. Horses.
- B. Potatoes.
- C. Sugarcane.
- D. Smallpox.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

In the 1800s, nationalism helped unite many German-speaking states into one country. During the same period, the Austrian Empire and the Ottoman Empire faced growing demands from Czechs, Serbs, Greeks, and other groups. Both empires also held grand royal celebrations in their capitals. What effect did nationalism have on these multiethnic empires?

- A.** It strengthened them by boosting loyalty at royal celebrations.
- B.** It strengthened them by uniting all subjects under one shared identity.
- C.** It had no effect on empires, because nationalism only unifies people.
- D.** It weakened them, as subject peoples pushed for their own nation-states.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

After plague killed roughly a third of Western Europe's population by 1351, some rulers passed laws to hold wages at pre-plague levels. Many churches also commissioned new art showing themes of death. What longer-term effect on labor did the population loss produce?

- A.** Most workers shifted into church art and building jobs.
- B.** The wage laws worked, so labor conditions stayed about the same.
- C.** Surviving workers gained bargaining power; wages rose and serfdom weakened.
- D.** Wages fell because fewer people meant less demand for work.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

In the late 1300s, English landowners faced higher wage demands, and peasants moved more freely in search of better pay. Which earlier event best explains this shift?

- A.** A population boom that flooded the labor market.
- B.** New laws that tried to freeze wages.
- C.** The Columbian Exchange.
- D.** The plague's sharp reduction of the population.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

Historians studying the outbreak of World War I note that the heir to the Austro-Hungarian throne was shot in Sarajevo in June 1914, ~~on a Sunday morning after his driver took a wrong turn~~. For decades before that, Europe's great powers had built rival alliance systems and raced to expand their armies. Which factor is best described as a root cause of the war rather than its trigger?

Target word: root cause, not trigger **Decides:** Alliances and militarism were long-term conditions that turned a local crisis into a general war.

A	Correct	A long-standing condition that made a wide war likely is a root cause.
B	Absolute language	The tensions were already in place; historians see the war as likely to break out over some crisis.
C	Camouflage	A vivid detail of the day; it does not explain why a single killing became a world war.
D	Confusion set	That is the trigger, the immediate spark, not the underlying cause.

2. Answer C Concept 1 • transfer

Which of the following was a trigger (immediate cause) of the French Revolution rather than a root cause?

Target word: identify the trigger — reverse of the root-cause question **Decides:** Calling the Estates-General in 1789 was the short-term event that set things in motion.

A	Confusion set	Also a long-term cause, not the spark.
B	Inverted operation	That is a root cause, the opposite of what is asked.
C	Correct	An immediate event that opened the crisis; the deeper causes were already present.
D	Adjacent category	A broad background condition, not the immediate trigger.

3. Answer B Concept 2

A student ~~writing her paper in the university library's rare books room~~ notes that the Western Roman Empire fell in 476 CE, a few generations after Christianity became its official religion. She concludes that Christianity caused the fall. Which is the best evaluation of her reasoning?

Target word: evaluate a single-cause claim **Decides:** Timing alone does not show causation; many factors were involved.

A	Absolute language	Religion can matter; the flaw is the single-cause leap, not that religion is irrelevant.
B	Correct	Large collapses have multiple interacting causes; sequence is not proof.
C	Camouflage	Where she wrote the paper does not decide whether the causal claim holds.
D	Dropped element	Drops the need for evidence of a causal link beyond order in time.

4. Answer B Concept 3

In the 1500s, a state ruled from a single capital over Turks, Arabs, Greeks, Armenians, and Slavs, and it let religious communities run many of their own affairs. ~~It fielded a famous infantry corps and controlled major trade routes.~~ How is this state best classified?

Target word: classify the state **Decides:** One center ruling many distinct peoples = empire.

A	Camouflage	Trade control is real but does not decide the type of state.
B	Correct	Rule by one dominant center over many ethnic and religious groups defines an empire.
C	Adjacent category	A city-state is a single city and its nearby land, far smaller than a multi-region state.
D	Confusion set	A nation-state bases its rule on one shared national identity, not many peoples.

5. Answer C Concept 3 • transfer

Which feature most clearly distinguishes a nation-state from an empire?

Target word: defining feature of a nation-state — reverse of classifying an empire **Decides:** Legitimacy rests on one nation inside its borders.

A	Inverted operation	That describes an empire, the opposite of what is asked.
B	Adjacent category	Military size measures power, not the type of state.
C	Correct	That match between people and state is what makes a nation-state.
D	Absolute language	Nation-states can be republics or monarchies.

6. Answer D Concept 4

Between about the 100s and 700s CE, merchants on the overland Silk Road carried silk, horses, and ideas between India, Central Asia, and China. Buddhist monks in China translated texts using existing Daoist terms, and Chinese Buddhism later blended with local ancestor-honoring practices. ~~Caravans could take months to cross the Taklamakan Desert.~~ Which process does this best illustrate?

Target word: name the process **Decides:** A religion spread by trade and blended with local beliefs.

A	Inverted operation	The stem shows the opposite: outside ideas entered and mixed.
B	Camouflage	Travel time is true but is not the process the evidence shows.
C	Adjacent category	Another way religions spread, but the stem describes merchants and monks, not armies.
D	Correct	Spread by travel plus blending with Daoist and local practice is syncretism.

7. Answer A Concept 5

The plague of the 1340s moved from Central Asia to the Black Sea and then by ship to Mediterranean ports within a few years. ~~Chroniclers in Italian cities described church bells ringing for funerals day and night.~~ Which factor best explains how quickly the disease crossed such distances?

Target word: why the spread was fast **Decides:** Linked Eurasian trade routes moved people, goods, rats, and fleas quickly.

A	Correct	The same network that carried trade carried the disease.
B	Inverted operation	Reverses the direction; it moved from Central Asia westward.
C	Absolute language	Local conditions mattered, but they do not explain long-distance speed.
D	Confusion set	Mixes in the Columbian Exchange, which began a century and a half later.

8. Answer A Concept 6

In the century after Spanish expeditions reached central Mexico in the early 1500s, the Indigenous population fell by as much as 90 percent. ~~The Spanish brought horses and steel weapons and formed alliances with rival Indigenous groups.~~ What was the leading cause of the population collapse?

Target word: leading cause of population loss **Decides:** Diseases like smallpox struck people with no prior exposure.

A	Correct	Epidemics killed far more people than warfare did.
B	Confusion set	Potatoes and maize went from the Americas to Europe, not the reverse.
C	Camouflage	These helped conquest but account for a small share of the deaths.
D	Inverted operation	Reverses the direction of the deadly disease flow.

9. Answer B Concept 6 · transfer

Which item moved from the Americas to Afro-Eurasia in the Columbian Exchange and later helped feed population growth there?

Target word: direction of flow — Americas outward **Decides:** Potatoes are native to the Andes.

A	Inverted operation	Horses moved from Europe to the Americas.
B	Correct	An American crop that spread to Europe and Asia and supported population growth.
C	Confusion set	Sugarcane was brought to the Americas and grown on plantations there.
D	Adjacent category	A disease, not a crop, and it moved into the Americas.

10. Answer D Concept 7

In the 1800s, nationalism helped unite many German-speaking states into one country. During the same period, the Austrian Empire and the Ottoman Empire faced growing demands from Czechs, Serbs, Greeks, and other groups. ~~Both empires also held grand royal celebrations in their capitals.~~ What effect did nationalism have on these multiethnic empires?

Target word: effect on multiethnic empires **Decides:** Subject peoples wanted their own states.

A	Camouflage	Ceremonies do not decide how independence movements affected the empires.
B	Inverted operation	That is what it did in Germany, where people already shared a language and culture.
C	Absolute language	Nationalism can also split states apart.
D	Correct	Nationalism pulls multiethnic empires apart.

11. Answer C Concept 8

After plague killed roughly a third of Western Europe's population by 1351, some rulers passed laws to hold wages at pre-plague levels. ~~Many churches also commissioned new art showing themes of death.~~ What longer-term effect on labor did the population loss produce?

Target word: longer-term labor effect **Decides:** Fewer workers meant labor was scarce.

A	Camouflage	The art detail does not decide the broad labor effect.
B	Dropped element	Leaves out the labor shortage, which the laws could not overcome.
C	Correct	Scarce labor raised its value despite laws trying to freeze wages.
D	Inverted operation	Reverses supply and demand; fewer workers made labor more valuable.

12. Answer D Concept 8 · transfer

In the late 1300s, English landowners faced higher wage demands, and peasants moved more freely in search of better pay. Which earlier event best explains this shift?

Target word: solve for the cause from the effect **Decides:** A sudden drop in population made labor scarce.

A	Inverted operation	More workers would push wages down, not up.
B	Adjacent category	Those laws were a response to rising wages, not their cause.
C	Confusion set	That began after 1492, a century too late.
D	Correct	Fewer workers gave survivors leverage over landowners.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	2	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	6	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	9	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	5	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	7	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	7	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Root cause vs. trigger	A root cause is a long-term condition that made an event likely; a trigger is the immediate spark that set it off.	Naming the dramatic final event as the cause of everything.	“Underlying,” “long-term,” or “root” vs. “immediate” or “sparked.”
2	Multiple causation, not coincidence	Large historical changes have several interacting causes; two events close in time do not prove one caused the other.	Treating sequence or timing as proof of cause.	A single-factor conclusion drawn from events that happened near each other.
3	Empire vs. nation-state	An empire rules many distinct peoples from one dominant center; a nation-state claims legitimacy from one people with a shared national identity inside set borders.	Calling any large or powerful state an empire, or any sovereign state a nation-state.	Many ethnic or religious groups under one ruler vs. borders drawn around one nation.
4	Cultural diffusion and syncretism	Ideas and religions travel along trade and travel networks and often blend with local beliefs as they spread.	Assuming religions spread only by conquest or stay unchanged when they move.	Merchants, missionaries, or pilgrims plus local practices mixing with a new faith.
5	Networks spread disease	The same trade, travel, and conquest networks that move goods also move pathogens, so connected regions suffer pandemics faster.	Explaining pandemics only by local hygiene or bad luck.	Speed or route of an epidemic across long distances.
6	Columbian Exchange demography	After 1492, Old World diseases such as smallpox, to which Indigenous Americans had no prior exposure, caused most of the population collapse in the Americas; crops like maize and potatoes flowed the other way.	Crediting the collapse mainly to battles and weapons, or reversing which way items moved.	Population loss in the Americas or “which direction” an item traveled.
7	Nationalism’s double edge	Nationalism unified people who shared an identity (German and Italian states) but broke apart multiethnic empires (Ottoman, Austria-Hungary).	Thinking nationalism only builds states and always strengthens them.	A multiethnic empire facing independence movements in the 1800s-1900s.
8	System effects and feedback	A shock to one part of a system ripples through others, often in unintended ways; for example, plague deaths made labor scarce, raising wages and weakening serfdom.	Assuming a disaster only makes every group worse off, or that laws alone fix an economy.	“Longer-term effect” of a population or economic shock.

Course scope (public description): This is World History: Diverse Cultures and Global Connections. In this course, you will focus on three main topics—cultural and religious diversity; pandemics; and the relationship of empires and nation states—as well as the skills of identifying root causes, explaining causes and effects, and analyzing complex systems. This course consists of an introduction and four major sections. Each section includes learning opportunities through reading, images, videos, and other relevant resources. Assessment activities with feedback also provide opportunities to practice and check how well you understand the content. Because the

course is self-paced, you may move through the material as quickly or as slowly as you need to, with the goal of demonstrating proficiency in the four competencies covered in the final assessment. If you have no prior knowledge of this material, you can expect to spend 30-40 hours on the course content.